

Word family: **bare / barer / barest / barely / bareness**

Base word: bare

Comparative: barer

Superlative: barest

Related forms: barely, bareness

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞) / verb (動詞)

Your sentence:

> “When a tutor and several students occupy a four-person table for two or three hours after ordering the **bare minimum**...”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **bare minimum** means **the smallest possible amount that is necessary or acceptable, with nothing extra**.

繁體中文： **最低限度；最少必需量；僅僅達到最低要求的程度**

中文翻譯：

> “...after ordering the **bare minimum**...”

「.....只點了**最低限度的東西 / 最少量的餐飲**之後.....」

Here:

the bare minimum = 能做到的最少程度，沒有任何額外部分

1. **bare = not covered by clothing (身體) — 裸露的；赤裸的**

This is one of the central literal meanings.

Practice 1

> “He walked across the sand in his **bare** feet.”

「他**赤腳**走過沙灘。」

Practice 2

> “Her **bare** arms were cold.”

「她**裸露的**手臂感到寒冷。」

****bare = 身體或身體某部分沒有衣物、鞋襪等遮蓋****

Common:

- * bare feet
- * bare legs
- * bare arms
- * bare skin
- * bare head

2. ****bare = uncovered / exposed, without a usual protective covering (物件 / 表面) — 裸露的 ; 沒有覆蓋的****

The word also applies beyond the human body.

Practice 3

> “The wires should never be left ****bare****.”

「電線不應該在沒有保護層的情況下****裸露****。」

Practice 4

> “The snow melted and exposed the ****bare**** rock.”

「積雪融化後，露出了****裸露的岩石****。」

****bare = 表面沒有通常應有的覆蓋物、保護層或遮蔽物****

Common:

- * bare rock
- * bare earth
- * bare floorboards
- * bare wire

This is closely related to Meaning 1, but broader.

3. ****bare = without leaves, vegetation, etc. (自然) — 光禿的 ; 沒有葉子的****

Practice 5

> “The trees were ****bare**** in winter.”

「冬天時樹木都變得****光禿禿的****。」

Practice 6

> “Only a few ****bare**** branches remained.”

「只剩下幾根****沒有葉子的光禿樹枝****。」

****bare = 植物失去葉子 / 地面沒有植被覆蓋****

For strict counting, this belongs to the broader “without normal covering” branch.

4. ****bare = empty or lacking furniture, decoration, contents, etc. (空間) — 空蕩的 ; 簡陋的 ; 沒有裝飾的****

A room, wall, shelf, etc. can be ****bare**** when it has very little in or on it.

Practice 7

> “The room was almost completely ****bare****.”

「房間幾乎完全****空蕩蕩的****。」

Practice 8

> “The walls were ****bare**** except for one photograph.”

「牆壁除了有一張照片外，幾乎完全****沒有裝飾****。」

****bare = 缺少通常會有的家具、裝飾、內容或物品****

Common:

- * bare room
- * bare walls
- * bare shelves
- * bare interior

This is a major extension from “uncovered.”

5. **bare** = plain, basic, with nothing extra (基本) — 簡單的；基本的；沒有額外內容的

Bare can mean stripped down to essentials.

Practice 9

> “The report gives only the **bare** facts.”

「這份報告只提供**最基本的事實**。」

Practice 10

> “The apartment had only the **bare** essentials.”

「這個單位只有**最基本的必需品**。」

bare = 只剩最基本、必要的部分，沒有細節、修飾或額外內容

This is the branch behind several important expressions such as:

- * bare facts
- * bare essentials
- * bare bones

6. **the bare minimum** = smallest possible amount (最低限度) — 最低限度；最少量

This is the exact construction in your passage.

Practice 11 — Original

> “They ordered only the **bare minimum**.”

「他們只點了**最低限度的東西**。」

Practice 12

> “He did the **bare minimum** needed to pass.”

「他只做了足以合格的**最低限度工作**。」

Practice 13

> “The company spent the ****bare minimum**** on maintenance.”

「公司在維修方面只花了****最低限度的費用****。」

****bare minimum** = 剛剛達到最低要求的程度，完全沒有額外付出******

This is a very important fixed expression.

7. ****bare** = only just sufficient / smallest possible (數量 / 程度) — 僅僅足夠的；最低的******

Beyond ****bare minimum****, ****bare**** can modify other nouns to mean extremely small or just sufficient.

Practice 14

> “The proposal passed by a ****bare majority****.”

「這項提案以****極微弱的多數****通過。」

Practice 15

> “They survived on a ****bare subsistence**** income.”

「他們靠着僅足以維生的****最低生活收入****過活。」

****bare** = 數量、程度等只比不足多一點點，幾乎沒有餘裕******

For core counting, this belongs with Meaning 5/6.

8. ****bare** = without protection / exposed to danger or conditions (暴露) — 毫無防護的；暴露的******

Practice 16

> “The equipment was left ****bare**** to the weather.”

「設備毫無遮蔽地****暴露於天氣之下****。」

Practice 17

> “The hillside was left ****bare**** after the fire.”

「火災後山坡變得**毫無植被覆蓋**。」

This remains conceptually tied to the uncovered/exposed branch.

9. **bare = verb: uncover a part of the body or object (動詞) — 露出；使裸露**

As a verb, **bare** means to remove or move aside a covering so something becomes visible.

Practice 18

> “He rolled up his sleeve and **bared** his arm.”

「他捲起袖子，**露出**手臂。」

Practice 19

> “The wind **bared** the roots of the tree.”

「風吹走泥土，使樹根**暴露出來**。」

****bare something = 移除遮蓋，使某物顯露出來****

This is a major verb sense.

10. **bare one's teeth = expose the teeth, often threateningly (笑 / 威嚇) — 露齒；齙牙**

Practice 20

> “The dog **bared its teeth**.”

「那隻狗**齙起牙來**。」

Often implies aggression or warning.

****bare one's teeth = 把牙齒露出來，通常表示威嚇、敵意或準備攻擊****

This is a fixed construction under the verb sense.

11. **bare one's soul / heart = reveal deeply personal feelings (比喻) — 袒露心聲；敞開心扉**

Practice 21

> “She **bared** her soul to her closest friend.”

「她向最親密的朋友**袒露心聲**。」

Practice 22

> “The memoir **bared** the author’s deepest fears.”

「這本回憶錄**揭露 / 袒露**作者內心最深的恐懼。」

Here:

bare = remove emotional concealment and reveal something deeply personal

This is a strong figurative extension of the literal verb.

12. **lay bare** = reveal or expose something previously hidden (固定表達) — 揭露 ; 暴露

Practice 23

> “The investigation **laid bare** serious weaknesses in the system.”

「調查**揭露了**制度中的嚴重弱點。」

Practice 24

> “The crisis **laid bare** the lack of preparation.”

「這場危機**暴露了**準備不足的問題。」

lay bare = 使原本隱藏或不明顯的真相、問題、弱點清楚顯露

This is one of the most useful figurative expressions in formal writing.

13. **bare bones** = most basic structure/information (固定表達) — 基本骨架 ; 最基本內容

Practice 25

> “The outline gives only the **bare bones** of the proposal.”

「這份大綱只提供提案的****最基本架構****。」

****the bare bones of something = 去掉所有細節之後剩下的核心結構****

This belongs to Meaning 5.

14. ****bare essentials = only absolutely necessary things (固定表達) — 最基本的必需品****

Practice 26

> “They travelled with only the ****bare essentials****.”

「他們旅行時只帶了****最基本的必需品****。」

Again, this is the “nothing extra” branch.

15. ****with one’s bare hands = without tools/weapons/protection (固定表達) — 赤手；徒手****

Practice 27

> “He moved the stones with his ****bare hands****.”

「他****徒手****搬動那些石頭。」

Practice 28

> “They caught the fish with their ****bare hands****.”

「他們****赤手空拳 / 徒手****抓魚。」

****bare hands = 沒有戴手套，也沒有使用工具或武器的雙手****

16. ****bare infinitive = infinitive without “to” (文法) — 原形不定詞 / 不帶 to 的不定詞****

In grammar, a ****bare infinitive**** is the infinitive form of a verb without ****to****.

Examples:

> “I saw him ****leave****.”

> “She can **swim**.”

Here **leave** and **swim** are bare infinitives.

繁體中文： **不帶 to 的不定詞 / 原形不定詞**

This is a genuine specialist compound and very useful for language learners.

17. **bare metal** = hardware without an intervening software/virtualization layer (科技) — 裸機；直接硬件層

In computing:

> **bare-metal server**

means a physical server used directly rather than running through a shared virtualization layer.

> **bare-metal programming**

means programming very close to the hardware, often without a full operating system.

繁體中文： **裸機；直接在實體硬件上運行的**

This is an established technical extension of:

> “with no extra layer covering/intervening.”

18. **bare trust / bare trustee** (法律) — 裸信託；名義受託人

In some common-law contexts, a **bare trust** is a trust in which the trustee holds legal title but has very limited or no active discretion over the property for the beneficiary.

bare trustee = 名義上持有法律所有權、但職能非常有限的受託人

This is genuine but clearly specialist.

Database status: legal/domain sense, not learner core.

19. **bare** = a lot of / many (英國都市俚語) — 很多；大量

In some modern British urban slang, especially Multicultural London English and related youth usage, ****bare**** can mean:

> ****many / a lot of****

Example:

> “There were ****bare**** people there.”

= 「那裡有****很多****人。」

Or as an intensifier in some slang uses:

> “That’s bare expensive.”

≈ 「那真的****很****貴。」

This is ****very different**** from the standard English meanings above.

****Database status:**** real modern slang, regionally/socially marked; useful for recognition but not standard formal English.

Related form: ****barely****

This one needs special care.

****Barely**** is historically/formally part of the same family, but its ordinary modern meaning has become:

> ****only just; almost not****

Practice 29

> “I could ****barely**** hear him.”

「我****幾乎聽不到****他說話。」

Practice 30

> “She ****barely**** passed the exam.”

「她只是****勉強****考試合格。」

Practice 31

> “There was **barely** enough food.”

「食物**僅僅**夠用 / 差點不夠。」

barely = 只勉強達到；幾乎沒有 / 幾乎不能

This semantic development is important enough that learners should not simply assume:

> bare + -ly = “in a bare way”

In modern English, **barely** behaves as an independent high-frequency adverb meaning **only just / hardly**.

Related form: **bareness**

Bareness means the quality/state of being bare.

Practice 32

> “The **bareness** of the room made it feel cold.”

「房間的**空蕩 / 簡陋感**令它感覺冰冷。」

Valid, but much less common than **bare**.

Important distinction: **bare** vs **naked**

naked

usually refers to a person/body with no clothes.

bare

is broader.

You can say:

- * bare feet
- * bare walls
- * bare branches
- * bare rock

* bare minimum

but not normally:

* naked minimum ❌

For body parts, ****bare**** often sounds less dramatic than ****naked****.

Important distinction: ****bare vs empty****

****empty****

means containing nothing.

****bare****

means lacking the usual furniture, decoration, covering, or contents.

> an empty bottle

> a bare room

A bare room may still contain a chair or table.

Important distinction: ****bare vs plain****

****plain****

means simple, not decorative or elaborate.

****bare****

often goes further:

> stripped of almost everything extra.

> plain room

> bare room

The second suggests more emptiness.

Important distinction: **bare vs exposed**

exposed

means left open to view, weather, danger, etc.

bare

means without covering.

A surface can become **bare**, which then leaves it **exposed**.

Important distinction: **bare minimum vs minimum**

minimum

= the lowest amount.

bare minimum

adds emphasis:

> absolutely no more than necessary.

So:

> “He met the minimum requirements.”

neutral.

> “He did the bare minimum.”

often suggests very little effort and may sound critical.

That nuance is important in your passage.

Important distinction: **barely vs hardly**

Both can mean “almost not.”

> “I could barely hear.”

> “I could hardly hear.”

Very similar.

But **barely** often emphasizes that something **just manages to reach a threshold**:

> barely passed

> barely enough

Important distinction: **barely vs merely**

barely

= only just / almost not

merely

= simply / only, without suggesting near failure

> “He barely passed.”

= 勉強合格。

> “He merely commented.”

= 他只是評論了一下。

Very different.

Grammar note: **bare + noun**

Common adjective patterns:

* bare feet

* bare walls

* bare branches

* bare essentials

* bare minimum

* bare facts

The exact Chinese translation depends heavily on what is missing:

- * covering → 裸露
- * furniture → 空蕩
- * decoration → 樸素 / 沒有裝飾
- * amount → 最低限度

But these are connected by the mental concept:

> **something expected or additional has been removed/absent**

Grammar note: **bare + object**

As a verb:

- > bare your teeth
- > bare your shoulders
- > bare your soul

Bare is transitive here.

Countability note

Bare is normally an adjective or verb, not an ordinary countable noun.

Bareness is usually uncountable:

- > the bareness of the landscape

Family-extension note

The practical family includes:

- * **bare**
- * **barer**
- * **barest**
- * **barely**
- * **bareness**

Useful compounds and expressions include:

- * bare minimum

- * bare essentials
- * bare facts
- * bare bones
- * bare hands
- * bare infinitive
- * bare metal
- * lay bare
- * bare one's teeth
- * bare one's soul

A thorough second-pass sweep also reveals:

- * **bare trust / bare trustee** — legal
- * **bare = many/a lot of** — marked British urban slang

The core conceptual image is:

> **normal covering, contents, protection, detail, or excess has been removed or is absent**

That explains most standard uses without artificially splitting every noun collocation.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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bare — body	身體 / 身體部位沒有衣物、鞋襪等遮蓋的；裸露的
bare — surface/object	沒有通常覆蓋物或保護層的；暴露的
bare — tree/land	沒有葉子、植被等覆蓋的；光禿的
bare — room/wall	缺少通常家具、裝飾或內容的；空蕩 / 簡陋的
bare — basic only	只剩最基本、必要部分，沒有額外內容
bare minimum	僅達到最低要求的最少程度 / 最低限度
bare majority etc.	數量或程度僅僅足夠、非常微小的
bare — verb	移除遮蓋，使身體、物件或事實顯露
bare one's teeth	露齒 / 齙牙，常表示威嚇
bare one's soul	袒露內心深處的思想或感受
lay bare	把原本隱藏的真相、問題或弱點揭露出來
bare infinitive	不帶 to 的不定詞 / 原形不定詞
bare metal	沒有中間軟件 / 虛擬化層、直接使用硬件的；裸機
bare trust	法律上的裸信託；專門
bare — slang	英國部分都市俚語：很多 / 非常；非標準正式用語
barely	僅僅；勉強；幾乎不

For your original sentence

> “...after ordering the **bare minimum**...”

The exact meaning is:

****bare minimum = 顧客只點最低限度、勉強足以算有消費的食物或飲品，完全沒有額外消費****

So:

> ****ordering the bare minimum****

= ****只作最低限度的消費 / 只點最少量的東西****

The phrase also carries a mildly critical implication in this context:

> they are taking up substantial restaurant space and time while purchasing ****as little as possible****.

For your database, I would count ****4 genuinely useful core meanings**** for standard ****bare****:

1. ****uncovered / naked / exposed****
2. ****empty, plain, or lacking normal contents/covering****
3. ****only the essential or minimum amount, with nothing extra****
4. ****verb — uncover, expose, or reveal****

I would keep ****bare minimum / bare essentials / bare bones / lay bare / bare one's teeth**** as important constructions, surface ****barely**** as a semantically developed family word, and retain ****bare infinitive****, ****bare metal****, legal ****bare trust****, and British slang ****bare = many/a lot of**** as domain/register extensions rather than inflating the ordinary core.